



# THE UNITED STATES

## LIFE IN THE 1860S:

~ *Settling the West* ~





## WARM UP

Describe in your own words what life was like in the United States during the 1860's. Be as specific as you can be.

THINK ABOUT...

- How did most people live?
- What was going on politically? Socially?



3



# MANIFEST DESTINY

Turn to a neighbor and talk about what you think Manifest Destiny means.



# 01 LIFE IN THE 1860S

## AGRARIAN SOCIETY ... **RURAL**

- Most Americans live on farms
- Candles for light
- Dawn/Dusk
- Self sufficient

## CITIES ... **URBAN**

- Unsanitary and primitive



# LIFE TRANSFORMED

## ELECTRICITY

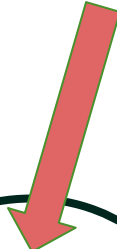
- Thomas Edison, Lewis Latimer, George Westinghouse

## TELEGRAPH

- Samuel F.B. Morse

## TELEPHONE

- Aka...the talking telegraph
- Alexander Graham Bell



How would  
life change  
with just  
these 3  
inventions?

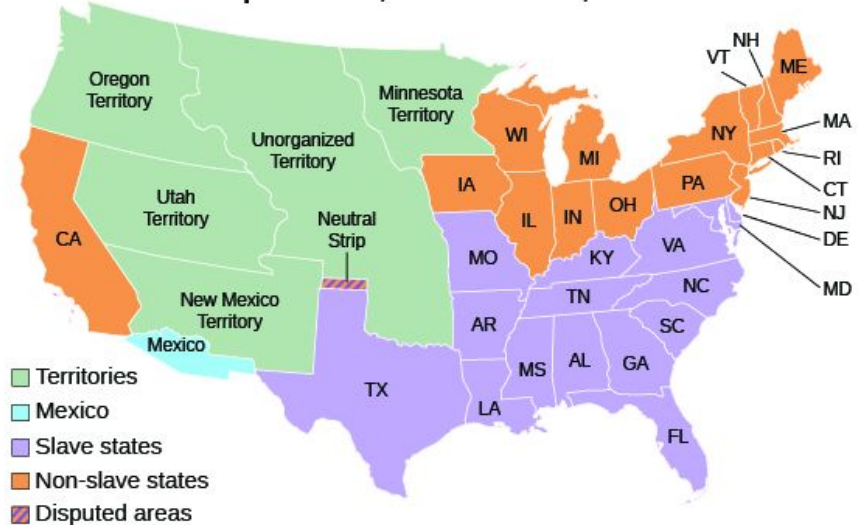




# OPENING THE WEST

There are geographic changes happening...

States and Territories of the United States of America  
September 9, 1850–March 2, 1853



**TECHNOLOGY +  
MANIFEST DESTINY =**

# **TRANSCONTINENTAL RAILROAD**



# Let's build a railroad!

INFRASTRUCTURE = streets, roads, transportation  
is needed to settle the country and promote economic and population growth

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**Why do we need to  
connect CA to the  
rest of the nation?**

**Why are people  
suddenly going to  
California?**

**What do we want to  
happen to the land  
in between CA and  
the rest of the  
nation?**

**What major US event interrupts  
the building of this railroad?**

# The Civil War

1860 - 1865

ACCOMPLISHMENTS

NORTH V. SOUTH

Who wins?

13 = abolish

North = industry,  
shipyards

14 = equal rights

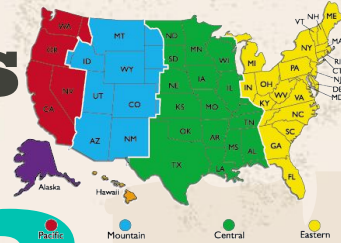
South = destroyed,  
“??? March”

15 = Black suffrage  
(*for men*)

**This is where  
you left off  
last year.**

# RAILROADS IN THE 1860s

What were they like?



## 01

### Limited & In the Northeast

Industry  
Factories, shipyards,  
population

|                                                                                   |                                         |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
|   | Meter Gauge<br>1000 mm<br>3 ft 3¾ in    |
|   | Standard Gauge<br>1435 mm<br>4 ft 8½ in |
|  | Broad Gauge<br>1520 mm<br>4 ft 11¾ in   |

## 02

### Short & Numerous

- Short routes, owned by a lot of different companies (rates vary, no standard gauge)
- There were **no safety regulations**
- No consistency

## 03

### Time & Danger

- Need for time zones  
Why?
- Government (gov't) regulation for safety standards



# THE TRANSCONTINENTAL RR

## [PART 1]

1700 miles of track



**Central Pacific**

from SACRAMENTO, CALIFORNIA  
to the EAST



**Union Pacific**

from OMAHA, NEBRASKA  
to the WEST

**Money & Land at stake...**  
**gov't incentives (land grants)**

**CP** hires  
Chinese  
immigrants

**UP** hires Irish  
immigrants &  
Black Americans

PROMOTORY

NEBRASKA

OMAHA

UTAH

NEVADA

SACRAMENTO

CALIFORNIE

**MAY 10, 1869**

**WHY?**

What is this way?

What is this way?

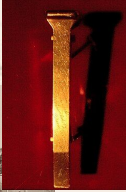
— Central Pacific  
— Union Pacific  
— Complété plus tard



# SETTLING THE WEST

## Transcontinental Railroads

- Completed in May 10, 1869 in Promontory, UT
- By 1900 there were 5 transcontinental railroads



## Homestead Act of 1862

- Need to settle land previously owned by France and Spain...they didn't colonize so it's up for grabs!
- Gov't has to motivate people to go into the wilderness → dream of "free land"
- Remember...LAND = **POWER/WEALTH**
- Gov't provides **160 acres** for **\$10** (\$389/2025) → must **cultivate** the land for 5 years (**Why 5 yrs?**)
- Between 1862-1900 **600,000** people moved West (many from other countries)

# TRANSCONTINENTAL RR RESULTS

## ECONOMIC CONSEQUENCES

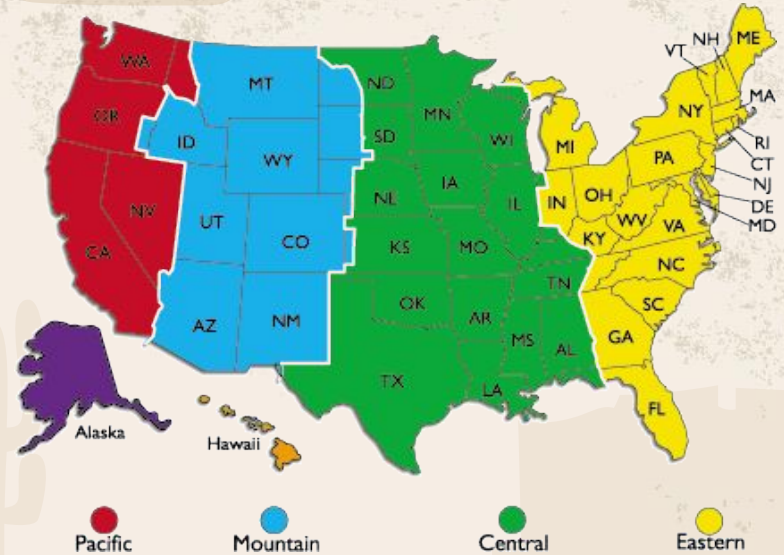
- Transported Goods & People
- Steel & Coal Mining

## GEOGRAPHIC CONSEQUENCES

- Permanent Settlements/Cities
- Indigenous Peoples removed from traditional lands

## TIME ZONES

- Consistency & Reliability
- Easier to make your train



# George Pullman

Watch: Pullman rail cars: A detour back through time (start-1:45)

- How is he connected to the railroad? What did he develop?
- Why was his company/development important to traveling by train?



# BUT HOW DID WE GET THIS LAND?



MEXICAN REVOLUTION

LOUISIANA PURCHASE

TREATIES & AGREEMENTS

